

JobXApply — Government Portal Compliance Tier

An addendum to the Portal Playbooks document: how the autofill engine should treat UPSC, SSC, IBPS, and state/central government recruitment portals differently from commercial job portals

Government recruitment portals are not just another entry in the Portal Playbooks table. They are official state systems, each with its own Terms of Use that may or may not address automated form entry, and the stakes of getting this wrong -- for a candidate's eligibility, and for JobXApply's standing -- are higher than a commercial job board. This document defines a separate, more cautious tier system specifically for these portals, and the review process for moving a portal from "unreviewed" to "cleared."

This document is not legal advice, and no specific portal listed here has been legally reviewed yet. It defines the process and the default cautious behavior while that review happens. Before marketing autofill support for government exam portals as a feature -- which matters a lot given how central this audience is to JobXApply -- get an actual lawyer to review a representative sample of portal Terms of Use (UPSC, SSC, at least one or two state PSCs). Everything below is designed to default to the safe side of that unknown, not to substitute for it.

1. Why This Needs a Separate Tier

Commercial portals (Naukri, LinkedIn, Indeed) generally expect and design around assistive tools -- browser autofill, password managers, and similar utilities are common and unremarkable. Government recruitment portals are different in three ways that matter here:

- **No single Terms of Use to check.** UPSC, SSC, IBPS, and each state's PSC, police, forest, judiciary, and railway recruitment board runs its own site, with its own terms, updated on its own schedule -- there is no single blanket answer for "government portals."
- **Higher-stakes fields.** A wrong value in a category/reservation-status field or an age-relaxation eligibility field can affect a candidate's actual eligibility for a government post -- a mistake here is a different order of consequence than a wrong value in a company name field on a commercial job board.
- **Different legal framing.** Terms-of-Use violations are a contractual matter regardless of portal, but government systems raise the same underlying question the Autofill Engine Spec already treats seriously for every portal: does the tool's behavior amount to unauthorized access or exceeding authorized access under India's IT Act, 2000 (Sections 43 and 66) -- a question that turns on whether any access-control measure (CAPTCHA, OTP, rate limiting) is bypassed, not on whether the portal happens to be a government one.

2. Legal Framework -- Plain-Language Summary, Not Legal Advice

Framework	What it covers	How it applies here
IT Act 2000, Section 43	Covers unauthorized access to or damage of a computer system.	Relevant only if a tool bypasses an access-control measure (CAPTCHA, OTP, session-token manipulation). A tool that only fills visible form fields, in the user's own authenticated session, without touching any security control, sits outside what this section is aimed at -- but this is a legal characterization, not a guarantee, and hinges on specifics a lawyer should confirm.
IT Act 2000, Section 66	Punishment for dishonest or fraudulent acts under Section 43.	Same dependency as above -- the dishonesty/fraud element typically concerns bypassing security or misrepresenting identity, not assisting a real candidate to fill their own real data into their own application.
Portal-specific Terms of Use	A contractual matter between the candidate and the recruitment body, separate from the IT Act.	A portal can prohibit 'automated tools' in its terms even where no law is implicated -- violating this risks account action or application rejection on that specific portal, not a criminal law problem. This is the most likely real-world risk and the reason for the review process in Section 4.

The practical takeaway carried into every rule below: **never bypass a security control (CAPTCHA, OTP), never auto-submit, and treat any portal whose terms explicitly prohibit automated tools as off-limits for autofill regardless of how well-behaved the automation is.** These three behaviors are what keeps this tool in "assistive typing" territory rather than "unauthorized access" territory.

3. The Three-Tier Compliance System

Tier	Criteria	Autofill behavior
Tier 1 -- Cleared	This portal's Terms of Use have been read in full by a qualified reviewer (ideally counsel), do not prohibit assistive automated form entry, and a review record exists (Section 4).	Full autofill available, same confidence-scoring and review-chip behavior as any Tier-1 commercial portal in the main Portal Playbooks doc.
Tier 2 -- Unreviewed (default for every new government portal)	No review has been completed yet, or the terms are ambiguous.	Autofill is available but gated behind an extra explicit warning (Section 5) -- "this portal's terms haven't been reviewed yet" -- every time, not just once. This is the default state and should stay the default until a portal is actively promoted to Tier 1.
Tier 3 -- Restricted	The portal's Terms of Use explicitly prohibit automated tools, bots, or scripts, or the portal is known to actively block/penalize automation.	Autofill is disabled entirely for this portal. The extension can still detect the portal and show field-count information for user awareness, but the fill action itself is not offered.

Every government portal starts at Tier 2 by default, with no exceptions. A portal only moves to Tier 1 after the review process in Section 4 is actually completed and recorded -- never based on an assumption that "it's probably fine" or on how popular/well-known the exam is.

4. The Portal Review Process (How a Portal Moves From Tier 2 to Tier 1)

1. LOCATE -> find the portal's actual Terms of Use / Terms and Conditions / Acceptable Use page (not just the homepage -- government sites often bury this a few links deep, e.g. under "Disclaimer" or "Terms of Service")
2. READ -> read it in full; do not rely on a keyword search alone, since a prohibition can be phrased many ways ("automated means," "bot," "script," "scraping," "unauthorized access," "system integrity," "manual entry only")
3. CLASSIFY -> does the text (a) explicitly prohibit automated form entry -> Tier 3, (b) explicitly permit or say nothing that would prohibit it -> candidate for Tier 1, (c) genuinely ambiguous -> stays Tier 2 pending legal review
4. LEGAL CHECK -> for any portal being considered for Tier 1, a qualified reviewer confirms the classification before it's promoted -- an engineer's or founder's own reading is not sufficient sign-off for this specific decision
5. RECORD -> log the review: portal name, URL of the terms reviewed, date reviewed, reviewer, classification, and a short justification -- this record is what makes the tier defensible later, not just a private judgment call
6. RE-REVIEW -> re-check every Tier 1 portal's terms on a fixed schedule (recommend every 6 months) and immediately after any visible redesign of that portal, since terms can change without notice

Review record template:

Field	Value
Portal name	
Terms URL reviewed	
Date reviewed	
Reviewed by	

Field	Value
Classification	Tier 1 / Tier 2 / Tier 3
Justification (short)	
Next scheduled re-review	

5. Starter Tiering Table (Honest Starting Point, Not Completed Reviews)

None of the portals below have actually been reviewed yet -- this table exists to make that explicit and give the review process somewhere concrete to start, not to assert a finding. Every row starts at Tier 2 until Section 4's process has genuinely been completed for it.

Portal	Current tier	Notes
UPSC (Union Public Service Commission)	Tier 2 -- unreviewed	High-profile, high-scrutiny national exam body -- review this one first given its visibility.
SSC (Staff Selection Commission)	Tier 2 -- unreviewed	Very high candidate volume in JobXApply's likely user base -- high priority for review.
IBPS (Institute of Banking Personnel Selection)	Tier 2 -- unreviewed	Same priority reasoning as SSC.
State Public Service Commissions (each state, individually)	Tier 2 -- unreviewed, per state	Each state PSC is a separate portal with separate terms -- do not batch these as one review.
State/central Police, Forest, Railway recruitment boards	Tier 2 -- unreviewed, per board	Lower initial priority unless user demand data says otherwise -- review opportunistically.

6. Additional Rules -- Stricter Than the Standard Autofill Spec

These apply on top of every existing rule in the Autofill Engine Spec, specifically for government portals:

- ✓ NEVER bypass a CAPTCHA or OTP challenge, under any circumstance, on any government portal -- this is the single clearest line between assistive tooling and unauthorized access, and it is absolute.
- ✓ NEVER auto-fill category/reservation-status, age-relaxation eligibility, or any other field that determines legal eligibility for a post -- these require manual entry every time, the same treatment as the knockout-question category in the Application Question Bank document, applied without exception on government portals specifically.
- ✓ ALWAYS show an extra explicit confirmation step before filling a Tier 2 portal's form, distinct from the standard review chip -- something like "This government portal's terms haven't been fully reviewed yet -- continue anyway?" -- so the user is making an informed choice, not assuming JobXApply has already cleared it.
- ✓ NEVER offer the fill action at all on a Tier 3 portal -- detection and field-count display only.
- ✓ ALWAYS apply the same self-imposed pacing as commercial portals (staggered field fill, no bulk/instant population) -- government portals are, if anything, more likely to have aggressive bot-detection given the sensitivity of what they administer.

Absolute prohibitions:

- ✗ Bypassing CAPTCHA or OTP on any government portal, for any reason.
- ✗ Auto-filling category, reservation status, or age-relaxation eligibility fields.
- ✗ Promoting a portal to Tier 1 without a completed, recorded review (Section 4).
- ✗ Marketing government-portal autofill support publicly before at least UPSC, SSC, and IBPS have genuinely completed legal review -- given how central this audience is to JobXApply, an early marketing claim that turns out to be wrong is a real trust cost.

7. How This Shows Up in the Product

- The Portal Playbooks document's per-portal table gets a new **Compliance Tier** column, alongside the existing ATS-safety column -- government portals are listed there with their tier, not folded into the general commercial-portal list.
- The extension's per-portal badge (already speced as green/amber/grey in the Design System document) gets a fourth government-specific state -- a distinct badge/label so a Tier 2 government portal is visually distinguishable from an ordinary amber "needs review" commercial-portal state, since the underlying reason is different (unreviewed terms vs. low field-confidence).
- The extension popup for a Tier 2 government portal shows the explicit warning from Section 6 every time, not just on first use -- this is deliberately more persistent than the standard one-time onboarding tone used elsewhere in the product.
- Any public-facing marketing copy (landing pages, the SEO/GEO content pillars) that mentions government exam form support should be reviewed against the actual current tier list before publishing -- claiming support for a Tier 2 or Tier 3 portal as if it were fully cleared would be inaccurate.

This tier list is a living document, the same way the Portal Playbooks field-maps are meant to evolve from real usage -- update it as reviews are completed, and treat Section 5's table as permanently incomplete until each row has an actual completed record from Section 4.